

Monday, August 15

Matthew was up by 7. I sat with him and read Lawrence's St. Mawr, and Matthew played with a Fisher-Price cash register. He turned the crank to open the drawer, took out a yellow coin, compared it with the coloured keys and the coloured fruit and then set it into the correct hole at the top. He pushed the yellow key to drop the coin into a channel and selected the "change" key to set it rolling into a side dish.

We talked more about Bill Sykes at breakfast. After, Peter practised cello. They are working on polishing pieces that Peter knows so that he will be ready to play with the older group.

I rode bike to the University. Cheryl took Matthew to Peter's swimming lesson. Peter thinks the lessons have become shorter. He gives a little flip of his hand and says: "The lesson was short today. All we did was do back floats with a kickboard, then we put on our life jackets, and that was all."

Matthew slept from 11 to 1. Cheryl sat with Peter, first writing out words with sh, ck and th and then working with word and picture cards - Cheryl would compete with Peter to read the word - whoever said the word that matched the picture got the card. In the end Peter lifted each card just enough to glimpse the picture; perhaps a different game. At 1 Peter rested and Cheryl went outside with Matthew. He climbed onto Peter's red tractor with pedals and heaved about on it without moving much. When Cheryl took him inside he gripped the steering wheel and cried.

After supper I mowed the lawns. Peter got a phone-call from Mama and Papa. He was invited to stay the night. We rode our bikes over. On Taylor, Peter slipped against the curb edge and skinned his knees and toes. After some tears and sitting on the sidewalk holding his leg he got back onto his bike and struck out in the lead. He showed his signals all the way. After a short visit Cheryl's parents headed to our place with Matthew and we returned on our bikes. We went to Ryden's Deli in Bedford Square. Peter, Matthew and I sat in a cutaway tub with faucets for Matthew to turn and Peter to pull off. Matthew dropped an empty glass fruit jar on the floor. Cheryl's dad spilled Tab onto his clothes. We talked

about Thursday's trip to Waskesiu, the Monday and Tuesday workdays at the farm, heart operations and hernias. Finally Peter said: "Mom, you have Mama to talk to, Dad is talking to Papa. I have no-one." By then it was 9. We were dropped off at home and we heard Peter call bye to us out the window, halfway down the dark street. Cheryl and I sat in living room and Matthew fell asleep on Cheryl's chest. We were in bed by 10:40.